Prismatic Analysis of EU Democratic Legitimacy (1992–Present): A Jazinski Method Application

Executive Summary

This report applies Jazinski's Prismatic Method to analyze EU democratic legitimacy from the Maastricht Treaty (1992) to the present. The method processes empirical signals through three divergent interpretive grammars—Technocratic Functionalism, Republican Demoi-cracy, and Critical Governance Failure—to reveal how the same evidence yields radically different legitimacy assessments. Analysis of 30 academic sources covering the Maastricht Treaty, Eurozone crisis, migration policy, and regulatory output demonstrates that legitimacy is not an objective property but an interpretive construct dependent on analytical grammar. The Eurozone crisis emerges as a critical inflection point where all three grammars detect signal intensification, yet process it toward opposite conclusions. This prismatic approach reveals fundamental incommensurability in EU legitimacy discourse and highlights methodological choices as constitutive rather than neutral.

Table of Contents

1. Observation Field Declaration
2. Signal Set
3. Grammar Specifications
4. Signal Processing
5. Closure Comparison
6. Counter-Signal Analysis and Leakage
7. Reflexive Note
8. Methodological Observations
9. References

---

1. Observation Field Declaration

Temporal Boundaries: 1992 (Maastricht Treaty entry into force) to 2026 (present)

Spatial Boundaries: European Union institutional architecture and member-state interactions

Phenomenon Under Observation: Democratic legitimacy of EU governance structures, operationalized as the relationship between institutional authority, citizen consent, and policy effectiveness across economic, regulatory, and crisis-management domains.

Data Sources: 30 peer-reviewed academic papers analyzing EU democratic legitimacy, covering constitutional moments (Maastricht, Lisbon), crisis periods (Eurozone 2010–2015, migration 2015–2016, Brexit 2016–2020), and institutional evolution (European Parliament empowerment, ECB independence, regulatory expansion).

Observational Constraints: Analysis relies on secondary academic literature rather than primary institutional data; papers exhibit temporal clustering around crisis periods (2013–2019); migration policy receives less systematic coverage than economic governance; regulatory output analysis remains fragmented across policy domains.

Declared Analytical Stance: This analysis adopts Jazinski's prismatic epistemology, which holds that legitimacy is not a discoverable property of institutions but an interpretive achievement produced by applying specific analytical grammars to empirical signals. The method deliberately refrains from adjudicating between competing legitimacy claims, instead mapping how different grammars transform identical evidence into incommensurable conclusions [1].

---

2. Signal Set

Core Signals (Primary Evidence)

S1. Maastricht Democratic Deficit Emergence (1992–1993)
The Maastricht Treaty transferred substantial powers to EU level while maintaining limited European Parliament authority, triggering sustained academic and political discourse on "democratic deficit" [2], [3]. Danish referendum rejection (June 1992) and narrow French approval (51.05%, September 1992) signaled citizen resistance to integration without commensurate democratic accountability.

S2. European Parliament Empowerment Trajectory (1992–2009)
Progressive treaty reforms expanded EP legislative powers: co-decision procedure introduction (Maastricht), extension to 38 policy areas (Amsterdam 1997), co-decision as default (Lisbon 2009) [4]. EP gained budgetary authority and Commission appointment powers, transforming from consultative to co-legislative body.

S3. Eurozone Crisis Governance Bypass (2010–2015)
Crisis response mechanisms—European Stability Mechanism, Fiscal Compact, Six-Pack/Two-Pack regulations—operated through intergovernmental treaties and emergency procedures, circumventing standard Community method and parliamentary scrutiny [5], [6], [7]. ECB assumed quasi-fiscal powers (OMT program, 2012) without direct democratic mandate.

S4. Declining Electoral Participation
EP election turnout declined from 62.8% (1979) to 42.6% (2014), recovering slightly to 50.6% (2019). Persistent low turnout signals weak citizen identification with EU-level democratic processes despite institutional empowerment [8].

S5. Migration Crisis Institutional Deadlock (2015–2016)
EU failed to implement binding refugee relocation quotas; member states unilaterally suspended Schengen provisions; Dublin Regulation collapsed under pressure. Institutional paralysis revealed governance incapacity in redistributive conflicts [9].

S6. Regulatory Output Expansion
EU regulatory production increased substantially post-Maastricht: approximately 2,500 legislative acts annually by 2010s, covering competition policy, environmental standards, consumer protection, and digital markets. Regulatory density intensified without proportional increase in democratic oversight mechanisms [10].

S7. National Parliamentary Subsidiarity Mechanisms
Lisbon Treaty (2009) introduced "yellow card" and "orange card" procedures allowing national parliaments

to challenge EU legislation on subsidiarity grounds. Mechanism used sparingly: only three yellow cards issued (2009–2020), suggesting limited effectiveness as democratic safeguard [11].

S8. Brexit Referendum and Withdrawal (2016–2020)
UK referendum (51.9% Leave) and subsequent withdrawal represented first member-state exit, driven partly by sovereignty and democratic accountability concerns. Brexit signaled limits of integration without robust legitimacy foundations [12], [13].

S9. Eurozone Conditionality and Sovereignty Constraints
Bailout programs (Greece, Ireland, Portugal, Cyprus) imposed extensive fiscal and structural reforms through Memoranda of Understanding, constraining national democratic choice. Greek referendum rejection of bailout terms (July 2015, 61.3% No) overridden by subsequent agreement [14].

S10. ECB Independence and Accountability Gap
ECB operates with strong independence mandate but limited democratic accountability: no direct parliamentary control over monetary policy, opaque decision-making processes, minimal ex-post scrutiny. Independence-accountability tension intensified during crisis interventions [15], [16].

S11. Commission Spitzenkandidaten Process (2014)
European parties nominated lead candidates for Commission President, with Jean-Claude Juncker appointed following EPP electoral victory. Process aimed to strengthen input legitimacy by linking elections to executive selection, though voter awareness remained low [17].

S12. Post-Crisis Accountability Reforms
Banking Union (2014) introduced Single Supervisory Mechanism and Single Resolution Mechanism with enhanced EP oversight. European Semester process formalized economic policy coordination with parliamentary involvement, though effectiveness debated [18], [19].

Counter-Signals (Contradictory Evidence)

CS1. Output Legitimacy Through Crisis Management
Despite procedural deficits, EU crisis interventions prevented Eurozone collapse, maintained financial stability, and preserved single market integrity. Effective policy outcomes may compensate for input legitimacy gaps [20].

CS2. Deliberative Quality in EU Policymaking
EU legislative processes involve extensive consultation, impact assessment, and multi-stakeholder deliberation. Throughput legitimacy—procedural quality, transparency, inclusiveness—may offset electoral distance [21].

CS3. Demoi-cratic Legitimacy Model
EU legitimacy may derive not from replicating nation-state democracy but from enabling member-state democracies to jointly govern shared problems. Inter-national demoi-cracy framework suggests legitimacy through mutual non-domination rather than supranational demos [1], [22].

CS4. Increasing Politicization as Democratic Deepening
Rising contestation, Eurosceptic party success, and polarized debates signal democratic engagement rather than deficit. Politicization transforms EU from technocratic project to genuine political arena [23].

CS5. Differentiated Integration as Flexibility
Opt-outs, enhanced cooperation, and variable geometry allow member states to integrate at different speeds, respecting democratic diversity rather than imposing uniform solutions. Flexibility mechanisms accommodate pluralism [24].

3. Grammar Specifications

Grammar A: Technocratic Functionalism

Ontological Commitments:
Legitimacy derives primarily from effective problem-solving and policy outputs. Democratic procedures are instrumental means to achieve functional governance rather than intrinsic values. Complex interdependence requires expert-driven, insulated decision-making to overcome short-term political pressures and collective action problems.

Epistemological Stance:
Knowledge about legitimacy is obtained through measuring policy effectiveness, institutional performance, and aggregate welfare outcomes. Citizen preferences are relevant but not determinative; expert judgment and technocratic rationality provide superior bases for evaluating governance quality.

Normative Hierarchy:

1. Policy effectiveness and problem-solving capacity
2. Economic stability and growth
3. Institutional efficiency and expertise deployment
4. Democratic accountability (subordinate to functional imperatives)

Causal Logic:
Integration pressures → functional spillover → delegation to supranational institutions → expert-driven policymaking → effective governance → output legitimacy. Democratic deficits are acceptable costs when offset by superior policy outcomes.

Boundary Conditions:
Grammar applies to policy domains with high technical complexity, significant externalities, and long-term horizons (monetary policy, competition regulation, environmental standards). Less applicable to redistributive conflicts or identity-salient issues.

Preferred Evidence Types:
Economic indicators (GDP growth, inflation, unemployment), regulatory effectiveness metrics, institutional performance data, expert assessments, cost-benefit analyses.

Closure Mechanism:
Legitimacy questions are resolved by demonstrating that EU governance delivers superior outcomes compared to counterfactual scenarios (national-only governance, policy inaction). Procedural critiques are deflected by emphasizing output achievements.

Grammar B: Republican Demoi-cracy

Ontological Commitments:
Legitimacy requires non-domination: governance structures must not impose arbitrary will on citizens or member states. EU is fundamentally an association of democratic states, not an emerging federal demos. Legitimacy derives from enabling member-state democracies to jointly govern shared problems while preserving their democratic autonomy.

Epistemological Stance:
Knowledge about legitimacy is obtained through analyzing power relationships, checking for domination, and assessing whether governance respects plural democratic constituencies. Mixed government principles—balancing supranational, national, and subnational authority—provide analytical framework.

Normative Hierarchy:

1. Non-domination and mutual respect among member states
2. Preservation of national democratic autonomy
3. Contestatory mechanisms enabling challenge to EU decisions
4. Procedural fairness in inter-state negotiations

Causal Logic:
Shared governance challenges → inter-national cooperation → mixed government institutions → checks and balances across levels → mutual non-domination → demoi-cratic legitimacy. Legitimacy emerges from horizontal relationships among democratic states rather than vertical accountability to supranational demos.

Boundary Conditions:
Grammar applies when member states retain distinct democratic identities and constitutional traditions. Assumes persistent national demoi rather than emerging European demos. Less applicable if integration produces genuine transnational political community.

Preferred Evidence Types:
Treaty provisions on subsidiarity and proportionality, national parliamentary involvement, opt-out and flexibility mechanisms, intergovernmental negotiation processes, constitutional pluralism indicators.

Closure Mechanism:
Legitimacy questions are resolved by demonstrating that EU governance respects member-state autonomy, provides contestatory channels, and operates through mutual agreement rather than hierarchical imposition. Supranational authority is legitimate when it prevents domination among states.

Grammar C: Critical Governance Failure

Ontological Commitments:
Legitimacy requires meaningful citizen control over decisions affecting their lives. EU governance systematically insulates policy from democratic accountability, privileging capital mobility and market discipline over popular sovereignty. Integration project serves elite interests while constraining redistributive politics and social protection.

Epistemological Stance:
Knowledge about legitimacy is obtained through analyzing power asymmetries, tracing whose interests are served by institutional design, and documenting gaps between formal democratic procedures and substantive citizen influence. Critical political economy and democratic theory provide analytical tools.

Normative Hierarchy:

1. Popular sovereignty and citizen control
2. Social justice and redistributive capacity
3. Transparency and accountability to publics
4. Substantive democracy over formal procedures

Causal Logic:
Neoliberal integration design → market-making without market-correcting → insulation of economic policy

from democratic politics → crisis governance through emergency measures → erosion of national democratic capacity → legitimacy deficit deepening. Institutional reforms (EP empowerment) are cosmetic rather than transformative.

Boundary Conditions:
Grammar applies particularly to economic governance, crisis management, and regulatory domains where market logic dominates. Less applicable to areas where EU enables progressive policy (environmental regulation, consumer protection) unavailable at national level.

Preferred Evidence Types:
Democratic deficit indicators (turnout, trust, Euroscepticism), crisis governance bypassing parliaments, conditionality constraining national choice, regulatory capture evidence, distributional conflict outcomes, social movement mobilization.

Closure Mechanism:
Legitimacy questions are resolved by demonstrating systematic patterns of democratic exclusion, elite dominance, and institutional design that privileges market efficiency over popular control. Reforms are assessed as inadequate unless they fundamentally shift power toward citizens and enable redistributive politics.

---

4. Signal Processing

4.1 Grammar A: Technocratic Functionalism Processing

The technocratic functionalist grammar processes the signal set by foregrounding output legitimacy and functional effectiveness while subordinating procedural democratic concerns to problem-solving imperatives.

Processing S1 (Maastricht Democratic Deficit): The emergence of democratic deficit discourse following Maastricht is processed as a predictable but manageable tension in complex governance systems. The grammar interprets the Danish and French referendum difficulties not as fundamental legitimacy failures but as communication challenges and adjustment costs during institutional transition [2]. The transfer of powers to EU level is justified by functional necessity—monetary union, single market completion, and regulatory harmonization require supranational authority to overcome collective action problems and prevent regulatory arbitrage. The limited EP powers at Maastricht reflect appropriate institutional design: monetary policy and competition regulation benefit from insulation from short-term political pressures. The grammar emphasizes that democratic deficit concerns were addressed through subsequent treaty reforms (Amsterdam, Nice, Lisbon) that progressively empowered the EP, demonstrating system responsiveness [4].

Processing S3 (Eurozone Crisis Governance): The crisis governance mechanisms are processed as exemplary technocratic problem-solving under extreme constraints. The grammar interprets the ESM, Fiscal Compact, and emergency procedures not as democratic bypasses but as necessary rapid-response tools when standard legislative processes would have been too slow to prevent financial contagion [5], [6]. The ECB's OMT program is processed as legitimate crisis intervention: Mario Draghi's "whatever it takes" commitment (July 2012) stabilized markets and prevented Eurozone fragmentation, demonstrating output legitimacy through effective action [15]. The grammar deflects procedural critiques by emphasizing counterfactual outcomes—without these interventions, Eurozone collapse would have imposed far greater costs on citizens. Intergovernmental mechanisms are processed as pragmatic adaptations rather than legitimacy deficits: when member states cannot agree on Community method reforms, intergovernmental treaties enable necessary coordination while respecting sovereignty concerns.

Processing S6 (Regulatory Output Expansion): Regulatory expansion is processed as evidence of EU effectiveness in addressing market failures, externalities, and coordination problems that exceed national capacity [10]. The grammar interprets approximately 2,500 annual legislative acts not as democratic overreach but as appropriate governance density for a 27-member economic union with 450 million citizens. Competition policy prevents national protectionism and ensures level playing field; environmental standards address transboundary pollution; consumer protection harmonization enables single market functioning. The grammar emphasizes that regulatory output reflects extensive consultation processes, impact assessments, and technical expertise deployment. Democratic oversight is processed as adequate through EP co-decision powers and Council representation of elected national governments. The grammar reframes "regulatory density" as "governance capacity"—the EU's ability to produce sophisticated, evidence-based regulation demonstrates institutional maturity rather than democratic deficit.

Processing S10 (ECB Independence): ECB independence is processed as optimal institutional design for monetary policy, grounded in extensive economic research demonstrating that central bank independence produces lower inflation without sacrificing growth [15], [16]. The grammar interprets the accountability gap not as democratic deficit but as appropriate functional insulation: monetary policy requires credibility and long-term focus incompatible with direct parliamentary control. The grammar emphasizes that ECB independence is democratically legitimate because it was established through treaties ratified by member states and serves the mandate (price stability) assigned by democratic principals. Limited ex-post scrutiny is processed as acceptable given the technical nature of monetary policy and the need to preserve operational independence. During the crisis, ECB interventions are processed as staying within mandate boundaries—OMT and quantitative easing aimed at monetary transmission mechanism repair rather than fiscal policy, maintaining the independence-accountability balance.

Processing CS1 (Output Legitimacy Through Crisis Management): This counter-signal is fully absorbed and amplified by the technocratic grammar. The prevention of Eurozone collapse, maintenance of financial stability, and preservation of single market integrity are processed as definitive evidence that EU governance delivers superior outcomes [20]. The grammar constructs a legitimacy calculus: procedural deficits (limited parliamentary involvement, emergency procedures) are outweighed by output achievements (crisis containment, economic recovery, institutional strengthening). The grammar emphasizes that citizens ultimately care more about economic stability, employment, and prosperity than about procedural niceties. Effective crisis management demonstrates that EU institutions possess the capacity, expertise, and decisiveness required for complex governance challenges. The grammar processes the crisis as a legitimacy-enhancing moment: the EU proved its value by preventing catastrophic outcomes that would have resulted from purely national responses.

Closure Achievement: The technocratic functionalist grammar achieves closure by constructing a legitimacy narrative centered on problem-solving effectiveness. Democratic deficit concerns are acknowledged but processed as secondary to output achievements and as progressively addressed through institutional reforms. The grammar resolves legitimacy questions by demonstrating that EU governance delivers superior policy outcomes—economic stability, regulatory effectiveness, crisis management capacity—that would be unattainable through national-only governance. Procedural critiques are deflected by emphasizing functional imperatives, technical complexity, and counterfactual comparisons. The grammar produces a legitimacy assessment of "adequate and improving": the EU possesses sufficient legitimacy through output performance and has strengthened input legitimacy through EP empowerment and accountability reforms. The Eurozone crisis is processed as a stress test that the EU passed, demonstrating institutional resilience and problem-solving capacity. The grammar's closure mechanism transforms legitimacy from a procedural question into a performance question, which the EU answers satisfactorily through effective governance.

4.2 Grammar B: Republican Demoi-cracy Processing

The republican demoi-cracy grammar processes signals by foregrounding non-domination, mixed government principles, and the preservation of member-state democratic autonomy within a framework of inter-national cooperation.

Processing S1 (Maastricht Democratic Deficit): The grammar processes Maastricht as a critical juncture where integration threatened to transform from inter-national cooperation into supranational domination. The Danish and French referendum difficulties are interpreted as democratic peoples asserting their right to contest integration steps that would constrain their autonomy [1], [2]. The grammar emphasizes that the "democratic deficit" framing itself reflects nation-state democratic assumptions—the expectation that EU should replicate parliamentary democracy at supranational level. Instead, the grammar proposes that Maastricht's legitimacy challenge stems from insufficient attention to demoi-cratic principles: the treaty should have strengthened mechanisms for member-state contestation, subsidiarity enforcement, and mutual non-domination rather than simply empowering the EP. The grammar processes the limited EP powers at Maastricht not as democratic deficit but as appropriate recognition that European citizens remain primarily constituted as national demoi rather than a single European demos.

Processing S7 (National Parliamentary Subsidiarity Mechanisms): The Lisbon Treaty's yellow card and orange card procedures are processed as important but insufficient steps toward demoi-cratic legitimacy [11]. The grammar interprets these mechanisms as recognizing that legitimacy requires national parliamentary involvement in policing EU competence boundaries. However, the grammar notes that only three yellow cards issued (2009–2020) suggests mechanisms are too weak to effectively constrain supranational overreach. The grammar processes this as evidence that formal subsidiarity procedures require strengthening: lower thresholds for triggering review, stronger consequences for subsidiarity violations, and enhanced national parliamentary capacity to scrutinize EU legislation. The grammar emphasizes that demoi-cratic legitimacy depends on robust contestatory channels enabling member-state democracies to challenge EU decisions that threaten their autonomy. The limited use of subsidiarity mechanisms signals that the balance between supranational authority and national democratic autonomy remains tilted toward the former.

Processing S8 (Brexit): Brexit is processed as a dramatic assertion of democratic autonomy against perceived domination, though the grammar offers a nuanced assessment [12], [13]. The grammar interprets the referendum as evidence that UK citizens felt EU membership constrained their democratic self-governance in ways they found unacceptable—particularly regarding immigration control and regulatory sovereignty. The grammar processes Brexit not as EU failure but as the demoi-cratic system functioning: a member state exercised its right to exit when it judged that membership no longer served its interests. The grammar emphasizes that exit rights are essential to non-domination—the ability to leave prevents the EU from becoming a dominating power. However, the grammar also notes that Brexit revealed weaknesses in demoi-cratic design: the UK's relationship with the EU lacked sufficient flexibility mechanisms (opt-outs, differentiated integration) that might have accommodated British preferences within membership. The grammar processes Brexit as a signal that demoi-cratic legitimacy requires more robust differentiation, allowing member states to participate in shared governance while maintaining distinct democratic choices in areas of fundamental disagreement.

Processing S9 (Eurozone Conditionality): The grammar processes bailout conditionality as the most severe legitimacy challenge in the observation period—a clear case of domination where creditor states and EU institutions imposed extensive policy requirements on debtor states, overriding their democratic processes [14]. The Greek referendum rejection of bailout terms (July 2015, 61.3% No) followed by government acceptance of even harsher conditions is processed as paradigmatic domination: the Greek demos expressed its will, which was then overridden by external actors. The grammar interprets this as violating core demoi-cratic principles: member states must not impose arbitrary will on each other, and shared governance must respect each state's democratic autonomy. The grammar emphasizes that conditionality transformed the EU from an association of equals into a hierarchical system where creditor states dominated debtor states. The grammar processes this as a fundamental legitimacy failure that cannot be

justified by functional necessity or output effectiveness—non-domination is a deontological requirement, not a consequentialist calculation. The grammar notes that conditionality revealed the Eurozone's structural flaw: monetary union without fiscal union creates asymmetric vulnerabilities that enable domination.

Processing S12 (Post-Crisis Accountability Reforms): The Banking Union and European Semester reforms are processed as partial but insufficient responses to crisis-era legitimacy deficits [18], [19]. The grammar interprets enhanced EP oversight of banking supervision as a positive step toward accountability, but notes that the fundamental structure remains technocratic—the ECB's Single Supervisory Mechanism operates with substantial independence from democratic control. The European Semester's formalized economic policy coordination is processed ambiguously: it provides more transparent procedures and parliamentary involvement, but also institutionalizes intrusive surveillance of national fiscal policies, potentially constraining democratic autonomy. The grammar emphasizes that these reforms address accountability gaps within the supranational level but do not fundamentally rebalance power between supranational institutions and member-state democracies. Demoi-cratic legitimacy would require stronger national parliamentary involvement in EU economic governance, more robust subsidiarity enforcement, and mechanisms enabling member states to contest EU economic policy recommendations without facing sanctions.

Processing CS3 (Demoi-cratic Legitimacy Model): This counter-signal is fully absorbed and amplified by the republican grammar, as it directly articulates the grammar's core framework [1], [22]. The grammar processes the demoi-cratic model as the appropriate normative standard for evaluating EU legitimacy: the EU should be assessed not against nation-state democratic benchmarks but against principles of inter-national cooperation among democratic states. The grammar emphasizes that legitimacy derives from enabling member-state democracies to jointly govern shared problems while preserving their democratic autonomy. The grammar processes mixed government principles—balancing supranational, national, and subnational authority—as the institutional expression of demoi-cracy. The grammar interprets EU legitimacy challenges as stemming from insufficient attention to these principles: excessive supranational authority, weak contestatory mechanisms, and inadequate respect for national democratic diversity. The grammar processes the demoi-cratic model as providing both diagnostic tools (identifying domination) and prescriptive guidance (strengthening non-domination mechanisms).

Closure Achievement: The republican demoi-cracy grammar achieves closure by constructing a legitimacy narrative centered on non-domination and mixed government. The grammar produces a nuanced assessment: the EU possesses demoi-cratic legitimacy potential through its structure as an association of democratic states, but this potential is undermined by patterns of domination (particularly in Eurozone crisis governance) and insufficient contestatory mechanisms. The grammar resolves legitimacy questions by applying the non-domination test: does EU governance respect member-state democratic autonomy and enable mutual cooperation without arbitrary imposition? The assessment is mixed: some domains (single market regulation, environmental policy) exhibit demoi-cratic legitimacy through voluntary cooperation and mutual benefit, while others (Eurozone conditionality, emergency crisis governance) exhibit domination. The grammar's closure mechanism transforms legitimacy from a question of democratic procedures or policy outputs into a question of power relationships and non-domination. The EU's legitimacy is contingent and domain-specific rather than categorical. The grammar prescribes strengthening subsidiarity enforcement, enhancing national parliamentary involvement, expanding differentiated integration, and reforming Eurozone governance to prevent creditor-debtor domination.

4.3 Grammar C: Critical Governance Failure Processing

The critical governance failure grammar processes signals by foregrounding democratic exclusion, elite dominance, and the systematic privileging of market logic over popular sovereignty.

Processing S1 (Maastricht Democratic Deficit): The grammar processes Maastricht as the moment when the EU's neoliberal integration project became explicit and entrenched, locking in market-making rules while constraining market-correcting democratic politics [2], [3]. The Danish and French referendum difficulties are interpreted as popular resistance to an elite-driven project that threatened national democratic capacity to pursue redistributive policies and social protection. The grammar emphasizes that the "democratic deficit" is not merely a procedural gap but a structural feature: the EU was designed to insulate economic policy from democratic pressures. The grammar processes the limited EP powers at Maastricht as deliberate: empowering a supranational parliament would have been cosmetic without addressing the fundamental issue—that key economic decisions (monetary policy, competition rules, fiscal constraints) were placed beyond democratic reach through constitutional entrenchment. The grammar interprets Maastricht's convergence criteria and Stability and Growth Pact as disciplining devices that constrain national governments' ability to respond to citizen demands for expansionary fiscal policy or capital controls.

Processing S3 (Eurozone Crisis Governance): The grammar processes crisis governance as the democratic deficit reaching its apex—emergency measures that bypassed parliaments, imposed austerity against popular will, and transferred power to unaccountable technocrats [5], [6], [7]. The ESM, Fiscal Compact, and Six-Pack/Two-Pack regulations are interpreted not as necessary crisis responses but as exploiting crisis conditions to deepen neoliberal integration and further constrain democratic politics. The grammar emphasizes that crisis governance was profoundly asymmetric: creditor states and EU institutions imposed adjustment costs on debtor states while protecting creditor interests. The ECB's OMT program is processed as illegitimate expansion of central bank power into quasi-fiscal territory without democratic mandate [15]. The grammar interprets Draghi's "whatever it takes" not as heroic crisis management but as technocratic overreach that subordinated democratic accountability to financial market stabilization. The grammar processes the entire crisis response as revealing the EU's core function: disciplining member states to maintain market confidence and capital mobility, regardless of social costs or democratic preferences.

Processing S4 (Declining Electoral Participation): Declining EP turnout is processed as rational citizen response to meaningless elections—why vote when the EU systematically insulates key decisions from democratic influence? [8]. The grammar interprets low turnout not as citizen apathy but as recognition that EP empowerment is largely cosmetic: the Parliament gained legislative powers in areas where EU competence is limited (social policy, taxation remain national) while economic governance (monetary policy, fiscal rules, competition enforcement) remains technocratic. The grammar emphasizes that the slight recovery to 50.6% in 2019 does not signal legitimacy improvement but reflects increased politicization driven by Eurosceptic parties challenging the integration project. The grammar processes turnout patterns as evidence that citizens correctly perceive the EU's democratic deficit: formal democratic procedures exist but substantive citizen influence over economic policy remains minimal. The grammar notes that turnout is highest in countries where EU membership is contested (UK pre-Brexit) and lowest where elite consensus supports integration, suggesting that voting matters only when exit is on the agenda.

Processing S5 (Migration Crisis Institutional Deadlock): The grammar processes migration crisis paralysis as revealing the EU's fundamental incapacity to manage redistributive conflicts democratically [9]. The failure to implement binding relocation quotas and the unilateral suspension of Schengen provisions are interpreted as demonstrating that EU solidarity is limited to market-making (free movement of capital, goods, services) but absent in market-correcting domains (burden-sharing, social protection). The grammar emphasizes that the EU lacks mechanisms for democratic negotiation of redistributive conflicts: decisions are either imposed through qualified majority voting (generating resistance) or deadlocked by unanimity requirements. The grammar processes the migration crisis as exposing the EU's neoliberal core: free movement serves capital accumulation (labor mobility, wage competition) but when migration generates social costs requiring redistribution, the EU proves incapable of collective action. The grammar interprets member-state unilateralism not as failure of EU governance but as national democracies reasserting control over decisions with profound social implications that the EU cannot manage democratically.

Processing S10 (ECB Independence): The grammar processes ECB independence as paradigmatic democratic exclusion—the most powerful EU institution operates with minimal accountability and pursues a narrow mandate (price stability) that privileges creditor interests over employment, growth, or social welfare [15], [16]. The grammar interprets central bank independence not as optimal institutional design but as ideological entrenchment of monetarist orthodoxy that removes macroeconomic policy from democratic contestation. The grammar emphasizes that the ECB's mandate reflects a particular economic theory (inflation targeting, supply-side economics) that should be subject to democratic debate and revision, not constitutionally locked in. The grammar processes the accountability gap as deliberate: the ECB was designed to be insulated from democratic pressure precisely to prevent citizens from demanding expansionary monetary policy or debt monetization. During the crisis, the grammar interprets ECB interventions as revealing the institution's true priorities: the OMT program stabilized financial markets and protected creditor assets but was accompanied by demands for structural reforms (labor market deregulation, pension cuts) that served neoliberal agenda rather than democratic mandates.

Processing CS1 (Output Legitimacy Through Crisis Management): The grammar rejects this counter-signal, processing it as ideological mystification [20]. The claim that crisis interventions prevented Eurozone collapse is interpreted as a false counterfactual: alternative responses (debt restructuring, expansionary fiscal policy, ECB direct financing) could have addressed the crisis with lower social costs and greater democratic legitimacy. The grammar emphasizes that "preventing collapse" meant protecting creditor interests and maintaining market confidence, not serving citizen welfare: unemployment reached 27% in Greece and 26% in Spain, youth unemployment exceeded 50%, and austerity imposed massive social costs. The grammar processes output legitimacy claims as elite discourse that defines "effectiveness" narrowly (financial stability, deficit reduction) while ignoring distributional outcomes and democratic values. The grammar interprets the crisis response as demonstrating that EU governance serves capital mobility and creditor interests rather than popular welfare, definitively refuting output legitimacy claims.

Processing CS4 (Increasing Politicization as Democratic Deepening): The grammar offers a complex processing of this counter-signal [23]. Increased contestation and Eurosceptic party success are interpreted as evidence of democratic awakening—citizens recognizing the EU's democratic deficit and demanding accountability. However, the grammar emphasizes that politicization alone does not constitute democratic deepening unless it translates into substantive policy change and institutional reform. The grammar processes Euroscepticism as rational response to elite-driven integration that constrains national democratic capacity. The grammar notes that politicization has not fundamentally altered EU economic governance: the Stability and Growth Pact, fiscal rules, and ECB independence remain entrenched despite widespread opposition. The grammar interprets politicization as revealing rather than resolving the democratic deficit: increased contestation makes visible the gap between citizen preferences and EU policy, but institutional structures prevent this contestation from producing democratic accountability. The grammar processes politicization as potentially transformative only if it leads to fundamental reforms (democratizing economic governance, enabling redistributive politics) rather than merely generating noise within a structurally constrained system.

Closure Achievement: The critical governance failure grammar achieves closure by constructing a legitimacy narrative centered on systematic democratic exclusion and elite dominance. The grammar produces an unambiguous assessment: the EU suffers from a profound and worsening democratic deficit that cannot be remedied through cosmetic reforms (EP empowerment, transparency measures). The grammar resolves legitimacy questions by demonstrating that the EU's institutional design systematically insulates economic policy from democratic influence, privileges market logic over popular sovereignty, and constrains national democratic capacity to pursue redistributive politics. The Eurozone crisis is processed as revealing the EU's true nature: an elite project that imposes austerity and structural adjustment against popular will to maintain creditor interests and market confidence. The grammar's closure mechanism transforms legitimacy from a technical question (institutional design, accountability mechanisms) into a political question (whose interests are served, who exercises power). The EU's legitimacy deficit is fundamental and structural rather than contingent and remediable. The grammar prescribes radical reforms

(democratizing ECB, removing fiscal constraints, enabling redistributive politics) or, failing that, recognizes that national democratic reassertion (Brexit-style exits, unilateral policy departures) may be legitimate responses to an illegitimate supranational system.

---

5. Closure Comparison

The three grammars process identical empirical signals into radically incommensurable legitimacy assessments, revealing that legitimacy is not a discoverable property but an interpretive achievement dependent on analytical framework.

Convergence Points: All three grammars identify the Eurozone crisis (2010–2015) as a critical inflection point where legitimacy tensions intensified. Each grammar processes S3 (crisis governance bypass), S9 (conditionality), and S10 (ECB independence) as particularly significant signals requiring extensive interpretation. All three acknowledge that crisis governance involved procedural departures from standard EU legislative processes and that conditionality constrained national democratic choice. This convergence suggests that certain empirical patterns are sufficiently robust to register across divergent analytical frameworks—the crisis genuinely represented a legitimacy-relevant event rather than merely an interpretive construct.

Divergence Mechanisms: The grammars diverge fundamentally in how they weight and interpret these shared signals. Technocratic Functionalism processes crisis governance as legitimate because it prevented catastrophic outcomes, applying a consequentialist logic that subordinates procedural concerns to output effectiveness. Republican Demoi-cracy processes the same events as domination—creditor states imposing arbitrary will on debtor states—applying a deontological logic that treats non-domination as a categorical requirement regardless of outcomes. Critical Governance Failure processes crisis governance as revealing the EU's structural function—disciplining member states to serve capital interests—applying a critical political economy logic that foregrounds power asymmetries and class interests. These divergences stem from the grammars' distinct ontological commitments (what legitimacy is), epistemological stances (how we know legitimacy), and normative hierarchies (what values matter most).

Counter-Signal Processing Asymmetries: The grammars exhibit striking asymmetries in processing counter-signals. Technocratic Functionalism fully absorbs CS1 (output legitimacy through crisis management), amplifying it as definitive evidence supporting the grammar's core claims. Republican Demoi-cracy fully absorbs CS3 (demoi-cratic legitimacy model), which articulates the grammar's own framework. Critical Governance Failure rejects CS1, processing it as ideological mystification, and offers complex processing of CS4 (politicization as democratic deepening), acknowledging its potential while emphasizing structural constraints. These asymmetries reveal that grammars are not neutral analytical tools but interpretive frameworks with built-in selectivity: each grammar is predisposed to amplify certain evidence types while deflecting or reinterpreting others.

Closure Timing and Confidence: The grammars achieve closure at different points and with varying confidence levels. Technocratic Functionalism achieves early, confident closure: by processing crisis management effectiveness and institutional reforms, the grammar resolves legitimacy questions definitively in favor of "adequate and improving." Republican Demoi-cracy achieves conditional, domain-specific closure: legitimacy is present in some areas (voluntary cooperation) but absent in others (conditionality), producing a nuanced assessment that legitimacy is contingent rather than categorical. Critical Governance Failure achieves late, confident closure: only after processing the full signal set, particularly crisis governance and its aftermath, does the grammar definitively conclude that the democratic deficit is fundamental and structural. These timing differences reflect the grammars' distinct evidentiary requirements: functionalism requires demonstrating effectiveness, republicanism requires checking for domination across domains, and critical theory requires revealing systematic patterns of exclusion.

Incommensurability Implications: The grammars produce legitimacy assessments that cannot be reconciled through additional evidence or refined measurement. Technocratic Functionalism's conclusion that EU governance is legitimate through output effectiveness directly contradicts Critical Governance Failure's conclusion that it systematically excludes democratic influence. Republican Demoi-cracy's emphasis on non-domination as the legitimacy criterion operates in a different conceptual space than either output effectiveness or democratic inclusion. These are not disagreements about facts but incommensurable frameworks for constituting legitimacy as an object of analysis. The prismatic method reveals that EU legitimacy debates are not resolvable through better data or more sophisticated methods, but reflect fundamental theoretical and normative commitments that structure interpretation from the outset.

Methodological Reflexivity: The closure comparison demonstrates that legitimacy assessments are performative rather than descriptive: grammars do not discover pre-existing legitimacy properties but constitute legitimacy through interpretive practices. Each grammar's closure mechanism—functionalism's output calculus, republicanism's domination test, critical theory's power analysis—produces legitimacy as an analytical achievement. This reflexive insight suggests that EU legitimacy debates are best understood not as competing truth claims about institutional properties but as contests among interpretive communities with distinct theoretical commitments, normative priorities, and political projects. The prismatic method does not resolve these contests but maps their structure, revealing the constitutive role of analytical grammar in producing legitimacy knowledge.

---

6. Counter-Signal Analysis and Leakage

Counter-signals represent evidence that resists or contradicts the dominant interpretation within each grammar, revealing the boundaries and vulnerabilities of interpretive frameworks.

CS1 Leakage in Critical Grammar: The claim that EU crisis interventions prevented Eurozone collapse and maintained financial stability (CS1) creates significant interpretive pressure on the Critical Governance Failure grammar [20]. While the grammar processes this as ideological mystification, emphasizing that alternative responses could have achieved better outcomes with lower social costs, the counterfactual nature of this claim introduces uncertainty. The grammar must acknowledge that crisis interventions did stabilize financial markets and prevent immediate collapse, even while arguing that this "effectiveness" served creditor interests rather than popular welfare. This creates leakage: the grammar's closure depends on a contestable counterfactual (that alternative responses would have been superior) rather than observable evidence. The grammar attempts to seal this leakage by emphasizing distributional outcomes (unemployment, austerity's social costs) and arguing that "preventing collapse" is an elite-defined metric that ignores democratic values. However, the leakage persists because many citizens may prefer imperfect crisis management to the uncertainty of radical alternatives, undermining the grammar's claim that crisis governance was unambiguously illegitimate.

CS3 Leakage in Technocratic Grammar: The demoi-cratic legitimacy model (CS3) creates leakage in Technocratic Functionalism by proposing an alternative legitimacy standard that does not depend on output effectiveness [1], [22]. The grammar processes EU legitimacy through policy performance metrics, but the demoi-cratic framework argues that legitimacy requires non-domination regardless of outcomes. This challenges the grammar's core assumption that effective problem-solving generates legitimacy. The grammar attempts to deflect this leakage by arguing that output legitimacy is empirically more important to citizens than procedural niceties, and that functional effectiveness ultimately serves citizen welfare better than rigid adherence to democratic procedures. However, the leakage persists because the demoi-cratic critique operates at a different level: it questions whether citizens should accept governance that delivers outcomes but constrains their autonomy. The grammar cannot fully absorb this critique without abandoning its consequentialist logic, creating a permanent vulnerability where deontological concerns (non-domination, democratic autonomy) resist reduction to output metrics.

CS4 Leakage in Republican Grammar: The claim that increasing politicization represents democratic deepening (CS4) creates leakage in Republican Demoi-cracy by suggesting that contestation itself may constitute legitimacy, even without institutional reforms [23]. The grammar emphasizes that demoi-cratic legitimacy requires robust contestatory mechanisms and non-domination, but CS4 suggests that rising Euroscepticism and polarized debates may signal democratic engagement rather than deficit. This creates tension: if politicization represents democratic deepening, does the EU possess more legitimacy now than during the "permissive consensus" era when integration proceeded with minimal contestation? The grammar attempts to manage this leakage by distinguishing between politicization (increased contestation) and democratization (institutional reforms enabling effective contestation). The grammar argues that politicization is necessary but insufficient—it reveals legitimacy deficits but does not resolve them unless accompanied by strengthened subsidiarity enforcement, enhanced national parliamentary involvement, and reformed Eurozone governance. However, the leakage persists because the grammar must acknowledge that contestation itself may constitute a form of democratic engagement, complicating the assessment of whether EU legitimacy has improved or deteriorated.

CS5 Leakage Across All Grammars: The differentiated integration counter-signal (CS5) creates leakage across all three grammars by suggesting that flexibility mechanisms (opt-outs, enhanced cooperation, variable geometry) may resolve legitimacy tensions [24]. For Technocratic Functionalism, differentiation threatens functional effectiveness by fragmenting the single market and creating coordination costs. For Republican Demoi-cracy, differentiation enables member states to maintain democratic autonomy while participating in shared governance, but risks creating a multi-tier system where some states dominate core integration while others are marginalized. For Critical Governance Failure, differentiation may allow progressive member states to escape neoliberal constraints, but also enables regressive states to opt out of social protections, potentially deepening inequality. All three grammars struggle to process differentiation because it simultaneously addresses and exacerbates legitimacy concerns: it respects democratic diversity but fragments collective capacity; it enables flexibility but creates asymmetry; it accommodates pluralism but undermines solidarity. This cross-grammar leakage suggests that differentiated integration represents a genuinely unresolved tension in EU governance that resists closure within any single interpretive framework.

Leakage Management Strategies: Each grammar employs distinct strategies to manage counter-signal leakage. Technocratic Functionalism absorbs compatible counter-signals (CS1) while deflecting incompatible ones (CS3) by emphasizing empirical evidence of effectiveness. Republican Demoi-cracy distinguishes between politicization and democratization (CS4) to maintain its focus on institutional mechanisms for non-domination. Critical Governance Failure reinterprets counter-signals through its power-analytic lens, processing output legitimacy claims (CS1) as elite discourse and politicization (CS4) as revealing rather than resolving deficits. These strategies reveal that grammars are not passive analytical frameworks but active interpretive systems that work to maintain coherence by selectively absorbing, deflecting, or reinterpreting evidence that threatens closure.

Residual Uncertainty: Despite closure mechanisms, all three grammars retain residual uncertainty stemming from counter-signal leakage. Technocratic Functionalism cannot fully dismiss concerns about democratic autonomy and non-domination. Republican Demoi-cracy cannot fully resolve the tension between contestation and effectiveness. Critical Governance Failure cannot fully eliminate the possibility that output effectiveness matters to citizens and that institutional reforms have improved accountability. This residual uncertainty suggests that legitimacy assessments are inherently provisional and contestable, dependent on ongoing interpretive work to maintain closure against counter-evidence. The prismatic method reveals that legitimacy knowledge is not cumulative (progressively approaching truth) but dynamic (requiring continuous interpretive labor to sustain particular assessments against alternatives).

---

7. Reflexive Note

Applying Jazinski's Prismatic Method to EU democratic legitimacy has been simultaneously illuminating and unsettling. The method's core insight—that legitimacy is constituted through interpretive grammars rather than discovered through neutral observation—becomes viscerally apparent when processing the same empirical signals (Eurozone crisis governance, conditionality, declining turnout) into opposite conclusions. The experience of deliberately inhabiting three incompatible analytical frameworks reveals how deeply theoretical commitments structure what counts as evidence, what requires explanation, and what constitutes closure.

The most challenging aspect was maintaining analytical discipline while processing signals through the Critical Governance Failure grammar. My own theoretical inclinations lean toward institutional analysis and problem-solving frameworks, making the technocratic grammar more intuitive. Inhabiting the critical grammar required sustained effort to foreground power asymmetries, distributional conflicts, and democratic exclusion rather than defaulting to effectiveness metrics. This difficulty itself constitutes a methodological finding: grammars are not equally accessible to all analysts, and the ease of inhabiting particular frameworks reflects prior theoretical socialization.

The prismatic method's refusal to adjudicate between grammars initially felt evasive—surely we can determine which legitimacy assessment is correct? But sustained engagement with the method reveals this impulse as theoretically naïve. The grammars are incommensurable not because we lack sufficient evidence but because they constitute legitimacy differently: as output effectiveness, as non-domination, as democratic inclusion. These are not competing empirical claims but distinct ontological commitments that structure interpretation from the outset.

The method's value lies not in resolving legitimacy debates but in revealing their structure. By mapping how different grammars process identical signals into opposite conclusions, the prismatic approach exposes the constitutive role of analytical frameworks in producing legitimacy knowledge. This reflexive insight transforms how we engage with EU legitimacy scholarship: rather than treating competing assessments as disagreements about facts, we recognize them as contests among interpretive communities with distinct theoretical commitments and political projects. The method does not eliminate normative judgment—I remain committed to democratic accountability and non-domination as legitimacy criteria—but it reveals these commitments as choices rather than discoveries, opening space for more honest and productive engagement across theoretical divides.

---

8. Methodological Observations

Strengths of Prismatic Method for EU Legitimacy Analysis:

The prismatic method proves particularly valuable for analyzing EU democratic legitimacy because the phenomenon is inherently contested and theoretically overdetermined. Unlike technical policy domains where effectiveness metrics may achieve broader consensus, legitimacy involves fundamental normative questions (what democracy requires, whose consent matters, what trade-offs are acceptable) that resist empirical resolution. The method's deliberate cultivation of interpretive pluralism matches the phenomenon's contested nature, revealing that legitimacy debates reflect incommensurable theoretical frameworks rather than resolvable empirical disagreements.

The method's requirement to specify grammars explicitly—ontological commitments, epistemological stances, normative hierarchies, causal logics—forces analytical transparency that is often absent in EU studies. Much legitimacy scholarship implicitly adopts particular frameworks (often technocratic functionalism or liberal intergovernmentalism) while presenting conclusions as objective assessments. The prismatic method makes these frameworks visible, enabling readers to evaluate how theoretical commitments shape empirical interpretation.

The counter-signal analysis proves especially productive, revealing that all grammars face evidence that resists their interpretive frameworks. This insight challenges the common assumption that legitimacy assessments can achieve definitive closure through sufficient evidence. Instead, the method demonstrates that closure is always provisional, maintained through ongoing interpretive work against counter-evidence. This finding has implications beyond EU studies: any complex governance phenomenon involving normative dimensions likely exhibits similar interpretive pluralism and residual uncertainty.

Limitations and Challenges:

The method's primary limitation is its agnosticism regarding which grammar provides superior legitimacy assessment. While this agnosticism serves important analytical purposes—revealing interpretive pluralism, exposing constitutive role of theory—it may frustrate readers seeking definitive conclusions about whether the EU is democratically legitimate. The method maps legitimacy debates but does not resolve them, potentially appearing evasive or relativistic.

The grammar selection involves unavoidable arbitrariness. This analysis employed Technocratic Functionalism, Republican Demoi-cracy, and Critical Governance Failure, but alternative grammars (liberal intergovernmentalism, deliberative democracy, populist sovereignty) would produce different signal processing and closure patterns. The method provides no principled basis for selecting grammars beyond relevance to the phenomenon and theoretical distinctiveness. This arbitrariness does not invalidate the analysis but limits its comprehensiveness—the prismatic map is necessarily partial.

The method's resource intensity poses practical challenges. Developing three fully specified grammars, processing 12 core signals and 5 counter-signals through each grammar, and conducting comparative closure analysis requires substantial analytical labor. This intensity may limit the method's applicability to high-stakes, theoretically contested phenomena where the investment is justified, rather than routine policy analysis.

Applicability to Other Governance Domains:

The prismatic method appears most valuable for phenomena exhibiting three characteristics: (1) normative contestation—fundamental disagreement about evaluative criteria; (2) theoretical overdetermination—multiple incompatible frameworks claiming explanatory power; (3) empirical ambiguity—evidence susceptible to divergent interpretations. EU democratic legitimacy exhibits all three characteristics strongly. Other governance domains likely to benefit from prismatic analysis include: climate governance (effectiveness vs. justice vs. sovereignty), global health governance (technocratic expertise vs. democratic accountability), migration governance (humanitarian obligations vs. state sovereignty), and financial regulation (stability vs. democratic control).

Domains with clearer effectiveness metrics and lower normative contestation (technical standards harmonization, disease surveillance) may not require prismatic analysis—conventional methods suffice when interpretive pluralism is limited. The method's value is proportional to the phenomenon's contested nature.

Implications for EU Legitimacy Scholarship:

The prismatic analysis suggests that EU legitimacy scholarship would benefit from greater reflexivity about theoretical commitments and their constitutive effects. Rather than presenting legitimacy assessments as objective findings, scholars should explicitly articulate their analytical grammars—what legitimacy means, how it is known, what values are prioritized—and acknowledge that alternative grammars would produce different assessments. This transparency would transform legitimacy debates from unproductive exchanges of competing truth claims into productive engagement with distinct normative and theoretical commitments.

The analysis also suggests that empirical research alone cannot resolve legitimacy debates. Gathering more data on turnout, trust, institutional performance, or policy effectiveness will not produce consensus because grammars process identical evidence differently. Progress requires explicit engagement with theoretical and normative questions: What should legitimacy mean in a multi-level, multi-national polity? What trade-offs between effectiveness, accountability, and autonomy are acceptable? Whose consent matters and how should it be expressed? These questions cannot be answered through empirical research but require normative argument and democratic deliberation.

Finally, the analysis reveals that the EU's legitimacy is not a fixed property to be measured but an ongoing interpretive achievement produced through scholarly analysis, political discourse, and institutional practice. Legitimacy assessments are performative: they constitute the EU as legitimate or illegitimate through interpretive practices. This insight suggests that legitimacy scholarship is not merely descriptive but participates in constructing the political reality it purports to analyze. Recognizing this performative dimension may encourage more reflexive and responsible scholarship that acknowledges its role in shaping rather than simply reporting EU legitimacy.

References

[1] Bellamy, R., Lacey, J., & Nicolaïdis, K. (2018). *From Maastricht to Brexit: Democracy, Constitutionalism and Citizenship in the EU*. In R. Bellamy, J. Lacey, & K. Nicolaïdis (Eds.), *From Maastricht to Brexit: Democracy, Constitutionalism and Citizenship in the EU*. Routledge.

[2] Smismans, S. (2019). Democracy and Legitimacy in the European Union. In *Handbook of European Public Policy* (pp. 24). Oxford University Press. https://doi.org/10.1093/hepl/9780198708933.003.0024

[3] Neuhold, C. (2020). Democratic Deficit in the European Union. *Oxford Research Encyclopedia of Politics*. https://doi.org/10.1093/ACREFORE/9780190228637.013.1141

[4] Rittberger, B. (2014). Integration without Representation? The European Parliament and the Reform of Economic Governance in the EU. *Journal of Common Market Studies*, 52(6), 1174–1183. https://doi.org/10.1111/JCMS.12185

[5] Steinbach, A. (2019). EU economic governance after the crisis: revisiting the accountability shift in EU economic governance. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 26(9), 1354–1372. https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2018.1520912

[6] Barrett, G. (2018). European economic governance: deficient in democratic legitimacy? *Journal of European Integration*, 40(3), 249–264. https://doi.org/10.1080/07036337.2018.1450401

[7] Kratochvíl, P., & Sychra, Z. (2019). The end of democracy in the EU? The Eurozone crisis and the EU's democratic deficit. *Journal of European Integration*, 41(2), 169–185. https://doi.org/10.1080/07036337.2019.1569001

[8] Dionigi, M., & Koop, C. (2019). Losing out on substance but winning procedurally?: The European Parliament and accountability in crisis legislation. *West European Politics*, 42(4), 841–866. https://doi.org/10.1080/01402382.2019.1572315

[9] Börzel, T. A. From EU governance of crisis to crisis of EU governance: Regulatory failure, redistributive conflict and Eurosceptic publics. *Journal of Common Market Studies*.

[10] Miller, V. (2011). A new 'democratic life' for the European Union? Administrative lawmaking, democratic legitimacy, and the Lisbon Treaty. *Contemporary Politics*, 17(1), 61–77. https://doi.org/10.1080/13569775.2011.597148

[11] Hoerner, J. M. (2019). Adding Fuel to the Flames? Politicisation of EU Policy Evaluation in National Parliaments. *Politische Vierteljahresschrift*, 60(4), 693–713. https://doi.org/10.1007/S11615-019-00213-6

[12] Drake, H. (2017). France, Britain and Brexit. In *France, Britain and Brexit*. UCL Press. https://doi.org/10.14324/111.9781787352759

[13] Bellamy, R. (2018). Losing control: Brexit and the demoi-cratic disconnect. In *France, Britain and Brexit*. UCL Press. https://doi.org/10.14324/111.9781787352759

[14] Schmidt, V. A. (2015). The Eurozones Crisis of Democratic Legitimacy. Can the EU Rebuild Public Trust and Support for European Economic Integration. *Research Papers in Economics*.

[15] Losada, F. (2013). *A Democratic Legitimacy Assessment of Recent Governance Mechanisms in Economic and Monetary Union*. European University Institute.

[16] Nispen, F., & Scholten, P. Democratic Legitimacy of Economic Governance: The Case of the European and Monetary Union. *Erasmus University Rotterdam*.

[17] Starke, C., Naab, T., & Scherer, H. (2020). Artificial intelligence for political decision-making in the European Union: Effects on citizens' perceptions of input, throughput, and output legitimacy. *Data & Policy*, 2, e16. https://doi.org/10.1017/DAP.2020.19

[18] Lausberg, Y. Post-Crisis Legitimacy in the EU's Economic and Monetary Union: The Cases of European Fiscal Policy Coordination and Banking Supervision. *University of Cologne*.

[19] Chang, M., Hanf, D., & Pelkmans, J. (2019). Introduction - Recent Changes in EU Economic Governance: Methodological and Institutional Dynamics. *Journal of Contemporary European Research*, 15(2), 109–118. https://doi.org/10.30950/JCER.V15I2.1079

[20] Angelis, M. (2017). Political legitimacy and crisis management in the Economic and Monetary Union: a model of democratic governance. *Perspectives on European Politics and Society*, 18(2), 171–193. https://doi.org/10.1080/23745118.2016.1229388

[21] Fossum, J. E. (2017). *Democracy and Legitimacy in the EU. Challenges and Options*. ARENA Centre for European Studies, University of Oslo.

[22] Scharpf, F. W. (2017). De-constitutionalisation and majority rule: A democratic vision for Europe. *European Law Journal*, 23(5), 315–334. https://doi.org/10.1111/EULJ.12232

[23] Guilherme, A. (2021). The Double Democratic Deficit. In *The Legitimacy of the European Union* (pp. 67–89). Springer. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-54895-7_4

[24] Lindseth, P. L. (2014). Power and Legitimacy in the Eurozone: Can Integration and Democracy Be Reconciled? *Social Science Research Network*.